

r/aiwars

Question on 'ai using water'.

Posted by u/Crafty_Reality_9725 • 0 points • 238 comments

I saw some people talking about 'ai using a lot of water' or 'ai data centers stealing our water'.

I don't get it, what's wrong with that?

How do you 'steal water'? Was the water owned by a specific person and stolen?

And to begin with actually, what's wrong with using water in the first place? I'm not sure, but I don't think Ai data centers chemically separate h2o into it's component elements and reduce the amount of water in a specific place.

Then again, I'm not sure, which is why I am asking. So enlighten me, plz.

(I am asking from a neutral standpoint. I do not side. Even tho I do hand work, I support and am completely fine with AI artists and AI art. Neither am I saying Antis (as a whole) are wrong or dumb or stupid or whatever.)

Comments

u/Titan2562 • 1 points • 2026-01-15 16:49 UTC

I also want to bring up that there's the topic of chemical runoff from data centers that can fuck with water supplies. It's not so much that the center is deleting water as it is rendering it usable by people nearby.

u/Severe_Refrigerator4 • 1 points • 2026-01-12 22:31 UTC

Data centers use water to cool down their machines.

It's not drinkable usually and is released into the water circle slightly warmer. Unless it is circulated, then it is kept and evaporates very slowly.

How much is really impossible to calculate, but nothing gets polluted.

u/ApocaSCP_001 • 1 points • 2026-01-12 17:37 UTC

It uses a ton of water, obviously wasting water is bad, the water cycle argument is stupid asf because it certainly isn't going back to the local areas it was extracted from.

u/Additional_Boot_8935 • 1 points • 2026-01-11 15:20 UTC

"Bro, the water..." argument is built on faulty non-validated data, thanks WaPo. A bunch of miserable left-flunkies and right-AI-is-a-demon cohorts who just need a new subject to rage-bait on. AI data centers are at the leading edge of water conservation and reuse.

But, let's just pretend all the "bro, the water..." antiAI folks were correct. Like any industry, technological advancements produce better results over time. Instead of raging about water, it would serve everyone better if they pushed for ways to make non-potable water into potable water (desalination plants, etc...). That way, more people have access to drinking water and AI data centers won't be falsely targeted, a win-win.

Also, many of these folks already access water consuming data centers for social media, search engines, streaming services, etc... they have about the same water footprint, so, that let's you know how full of it they already are.

u/MuchSpecializtSoPro • 1 points • 2026-01-11 05:17 UTC

Freshwater is an unrenewable resource and it's expensive to produce. Most of the freshwater in the world is locked up in glaciers, which melt into the ocean.